

Words ending in -tion, -sion, or -ssion

THREE DIFFERENT SUFFIXES CAN REPRESENT THE “SHUN” SOUND AT THE END OF A WORD.

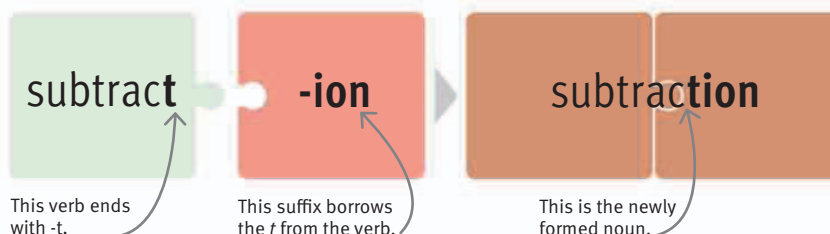
The suffixes -tion, -sion, and -ssion make a “shun” sound. Certain rules are helpful when choosing the correct ending to put at the end of a word.

Words ending in -tion

The suffix -tion means “the act of.” For instance, *digestion* means “the act of digesting.” Most verbs that take the -tion ending already end in -t, so only -ion needs to be added. This suffix is the most common ending.

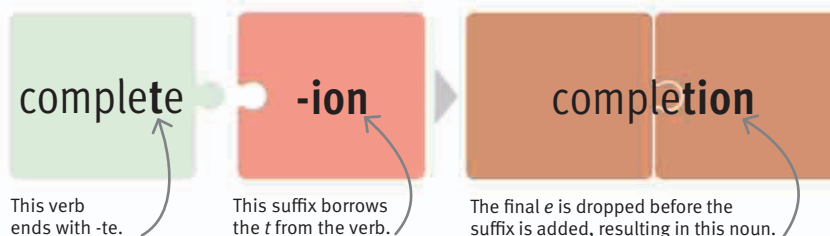
▷ Rule 1

If a verb ends in -t, then add -ion to avoid a double *t* before the suffix.



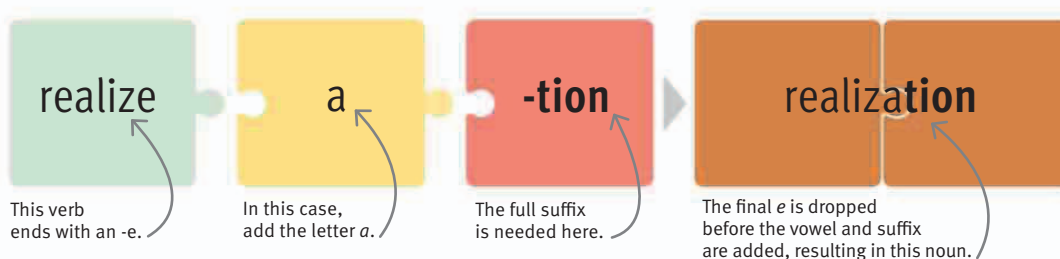
▷ Rule 2

If a verb ends in -te, then remove the *e* and add -ion.



▷ Rule 3

Some verbs drop the last letter and add an extra vowel before the suffix. To find out which vowel to add, always check a dictionary.



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GLOSSARY

Consonant A letter of the alphabet that is not a vowel.

Noun A word that refers to a person, place, or thing.

Suffix A group of letters attached to the end of a word that can change the original word's meaning.

Verb A word that describes an action.

Vowel One of the five letters *a*, *e*, *i*, *o*, and *u*.